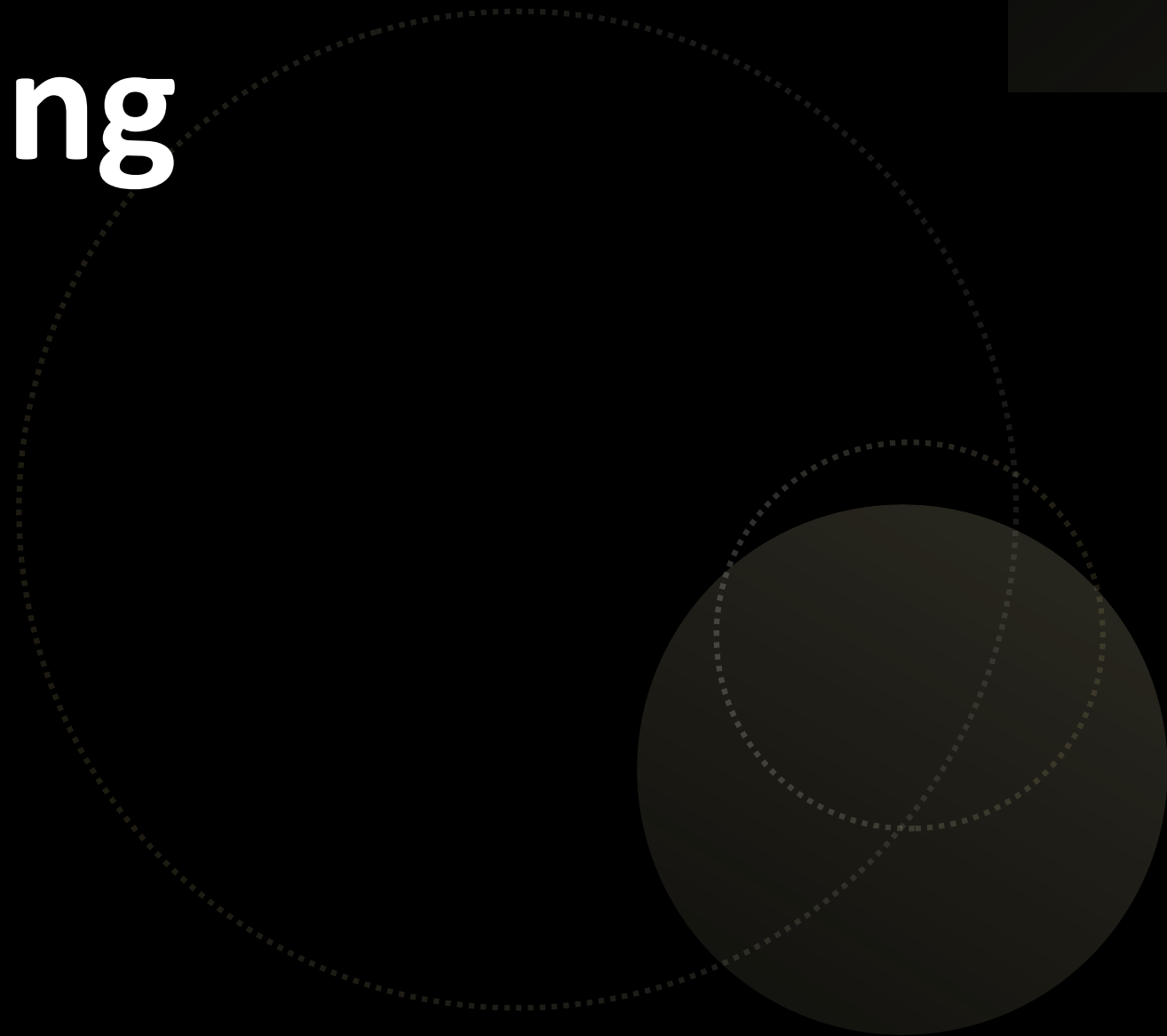
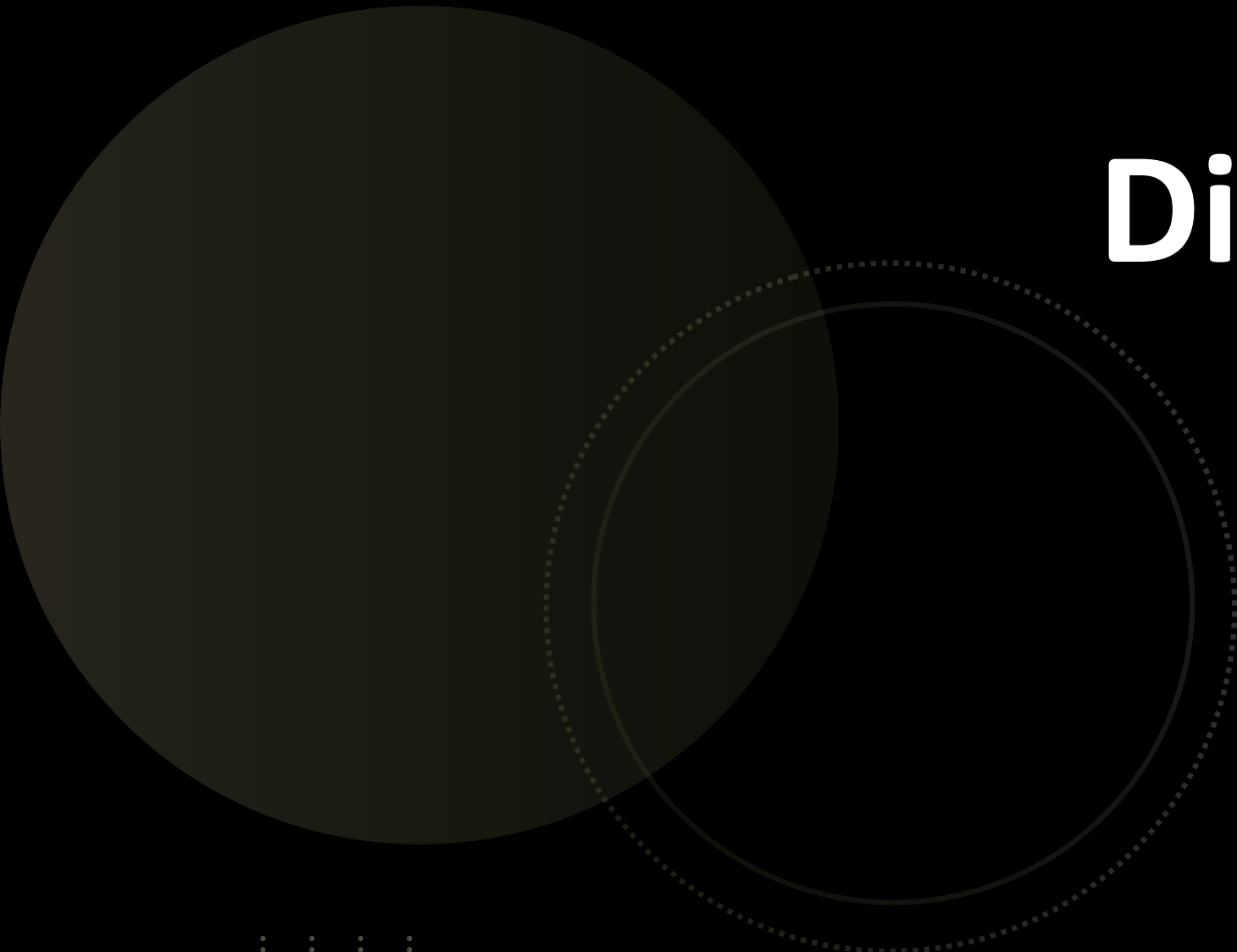


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# Digital Marketing

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# Introduction to SEO

- **What is SEO?**
- **Types of Search Engines**
- **How Search Engines Work?**
- **Understanding SERPs**
- **SEO Approaches (White hat/Black Hat/Grey Hat)**
- **Technical SEO, Onpage SEO & Offpage SEO**
- **Identify your niche & audiences**
- **Introduction to Keywords**
- **Keywords Research (Relevancy, Searches, Competition)Low Entry Resistance**

# How much does it take for a website to rank in Google?

- It depends on different factors:
- Industry/niche
- Target region
- Domain age
- SEO efforts/strategy

Usually it requires 3-6 months.

# How do search engines work (being SEO specialist)?

- Google, Yahoo, Bing ----> Search engine crawlers/bots/spiders/robots ---> Google bot, Bingbot
- Search engine crawlers crawls(read) websites ----> make a copy of pages being crawled ---> store copy in its database (datacenters)-- this process is known as “indexing/indexation”
- A user searches on Google ---> Google shows results from its database
- So, the sequence is:
- Google ---> website crawl ---> index ---> rank

# How do search engines work (being SEO specialist)? (Cont...)

- Q: How frequently does Google crawl/index our website?
- Ans: Normally it takes 3 days to four weeks. The timing depends on different factors:
  - 1.) Website popularity/traffic --- good SEO
  - 2.) Website updates (How frequently it is updated with new content, page, data, etc)
- This is called “Crawling frequency” and it is different for different websites and depend upon the above mentioned factors.
- => How to see when a website was crawled last time?
- Ans: Write a command on browser, “cache:websiteurl.com” and you will see the date along with the time.



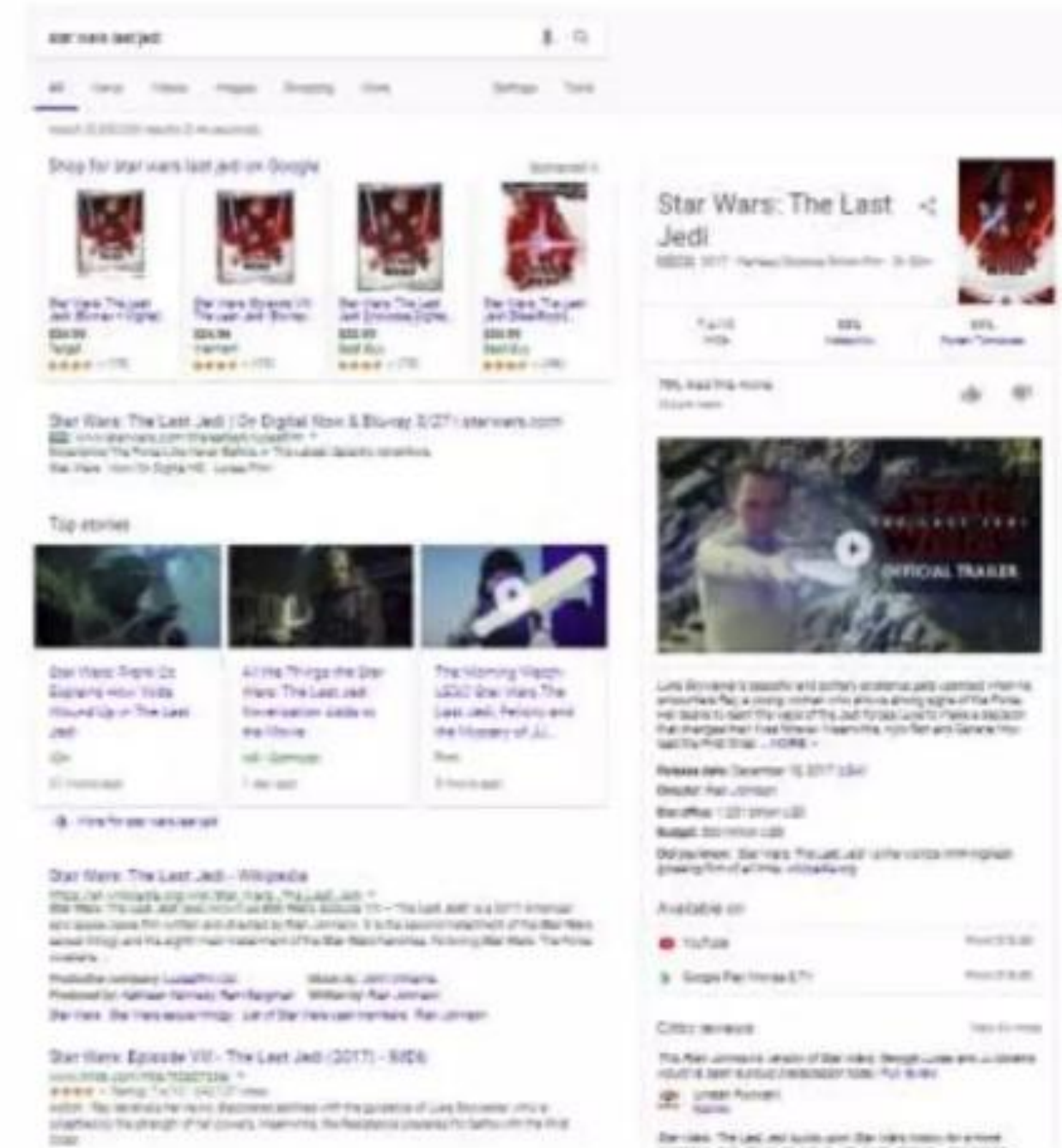
# How do search engines work (being SEO specialist)?

## (Cont...)

- Google SERP ---> Search engine result page
- Organic result ---> results obtained by applying SEO
- Organic traffic
- Organic ranking
- --> sponsored content (ads.google.com) --> for promoting websites
- --> SERP Structure normally:
  - - Some sponsored/paid results (around 4-5 results)
  - -(7-10) SEO results - organic traffic
  - - Upto 3 more paid results

# Structure of a SERP (Search Engine Result Page)

- \* Keyword / Search Query
- \* Paid Product Listings
- \* Paid Search Results
- \* Organic Search Results



## SEO Approaches:

1. White hat SEO → legal, ethical → avoid Google penalty, long term rankings, time taking → improve website speed, quality content, mobile experience improve
2. Black hat SEO → illegal, unethical → shortcuts → Google Penalty →
3. Grey hat SEO → grey area between Black hat & White hat SEO → can be used with caution →

Google's ranking factors → 200 ranking factors

## Main Factors of SEO:

1. **Onpage SEO** → factors directly related to website pages e.g website speed, content quality
  - a. Keyword Research/Keyword Placement/Content Creation
  - b. Technical SEO
2. **Offpage SEO** → popularity, social media presence



# 3 Keys to Higher Search Engine Rankings

## Code

Create a cleanly  
coded, search  
engine friendly  
website

## Community

Be found on the web,  
promote your great  
content

## Content

Produce great  
content

# SEO Learning Roadmap

- Onpage SEO - Keyword research
- Onpage SEO - Keyword placement
- Onpage SEO - Content Creation
- Onpage SEO - Technical SEO
- Offpage SEO
- Local SEO

# On-page Optimization

- Keywords Placement
- Anatomy of a SEO friendly webpage
- Descriptive URLs
- HTML Basics for SEO (SEO related HTML Tags)
- Title (keyword + USP | Brand name)
- Meta Description (keywords+brand name+USP+power words)
- Heading tags, h1,....h6
- H1 (should be only one on one webpage)
- Bold Keywords
- Contextual Internal Linking (user experience, search engines)
- Image Alt Tags

# Keywords

- Primary Keywords vs Secondary keywords
- Long Tail Keywords Vs Short Tail Keywords
- Keyword Clustering or Grouping of closely related keywords for every webpage
- Analyzing competitor websites for Keywords

# Keyword Research

- Ecommerce site
- Services website
- Blogging

For example we look for services first

1.) Services --> Food delivery

Website name is --> yummyfood.pk

Target region --> karachi, lahore, islamabad

Page 1 --> yummyfood.pk/karachi/

Now i want to rank this page in Google? What should be the keywords for this page?



## Keyword Research (Cont...)

Keywords ---> search queries related to our pages on which we want to rank.

Keywords could be: (Our guess)

food delivery in karachi (yes)

fast food delivery in karachi (yes)

order food in karachi (yes)

Quality food delivery karachi (yes)

restaurant near karachi ? (NO) -- WHY

But which one is the best ? On which basis should we select the keyword?

In Digital marketing, we don't guess, we check numbers.

# SEO Keyword Research Tools

- 1.) Ahrefs/SEMrush ---> paid tools
- 2.) Chatgpt for guessing keywords

Q: How to use SEMrush for keyword research?

Go on SEMrush tool on your browser --> Keyword overview --->Enter your keywords

**Keyword Selection Criteria:**

**Volume** --> how many times this keyword is being searched (monthly search volume)-- e.g. if it's 480 then it means if this keyword is ranked, then the no. of people on this score who can come to your website is around 400-420

--> Higher the search volume, more is the traffic

# SEO Keyword Research Tools

## Keyword Selection Criteria:

**Volume** --> how many times this keyword is searched (monthly search volume)-- e.g. if it's 480 then it means if this keyword is ranked, then the no. of people on this score who can come to your website is around 400-420

--> Higher the search volume, more is the traffic

--> KD --> Keyword Difficulty - It means how difficult it is to rank on that keyword

--> If the keyword difficulty is between 0-20, then it means it is very easy to rank on that keyword (less difficulty means less competition)

KD ---> (0-20) ---> Very easy to rank

KD ---> (20-35) ---> Easy to rank

KD ---> (35-45) ---> Hard to rank

KD ---> (45-60) ---> Very hard to rank

KD ---> < 60 ---> Don't go for such keyword

CPC - Cost per click - not related to SEO (This is something that comes in Google Ads module)



# SEO Keyword Research Tools

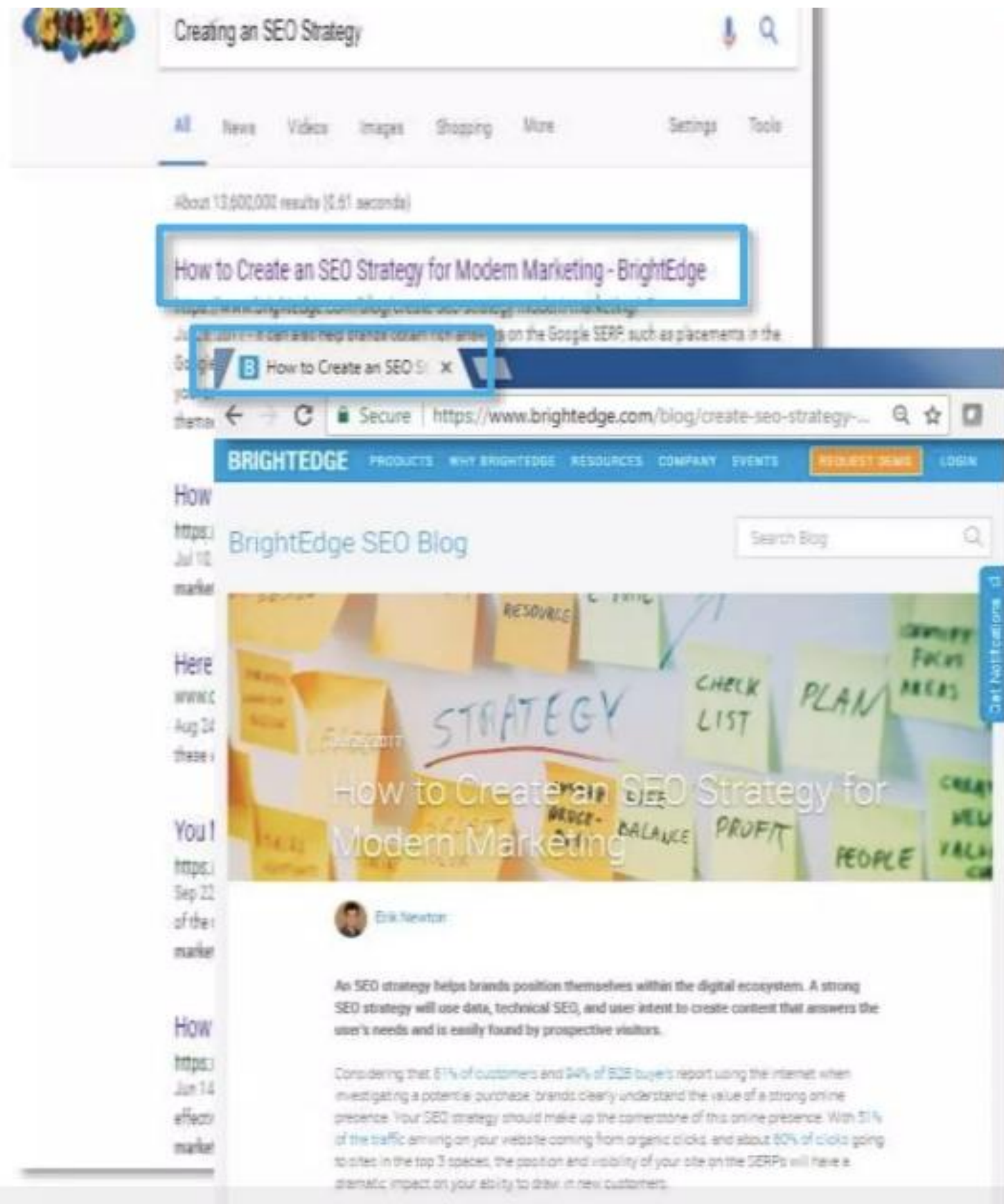
Intent - **What is intent ?**

1.) C and T - type ---> It means commercial/transitional intent - the intent is buying - e.g for jewellery store (buy jewellery)

1.) I type ---> It mean information --> keywords are like “how to make jewellery etc, how to clean jewellery at home, etc”

Question: One should rank their jewellery store website on commercial keywords or informational keywords?

# Title Tags



## Why is it important?

Title is the **most important** on-page ranking factor and is the main text that describes an online document.

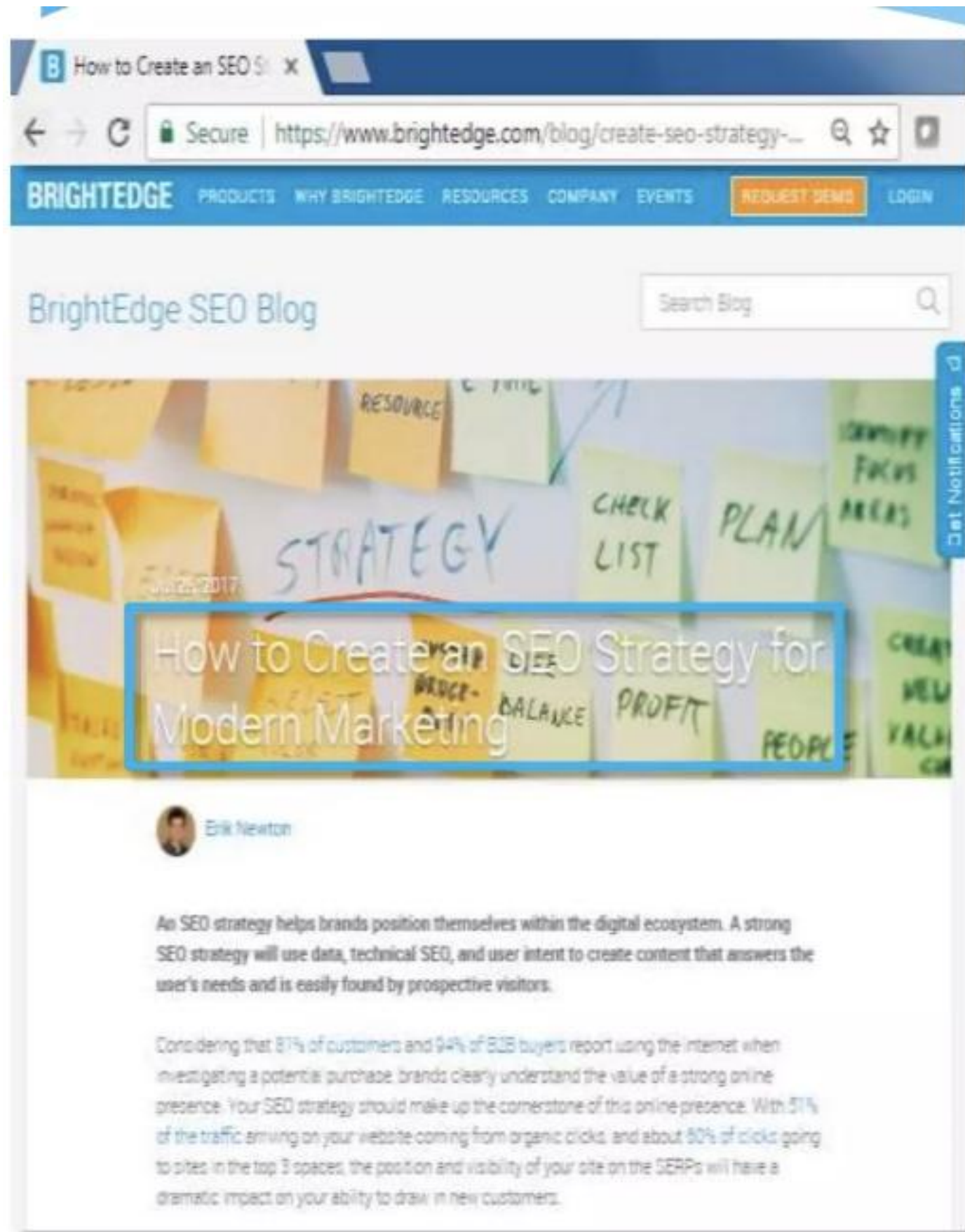
## What it looks like in the source code:

### Recommendation

- Use rich keyword phrases that best describe the web page
- Make them unique for each page and use a strong CTA (Call to Action) based on buyer intent
- Try to keep them around 55-65 characters long



# Tags



## What is it?

On-page HTML tags are located within the body copy that identify the most important text on the page. The H1 is the headline of the page. There are 6 header tags, ranging from H1 (the most important) to H6 (least important).

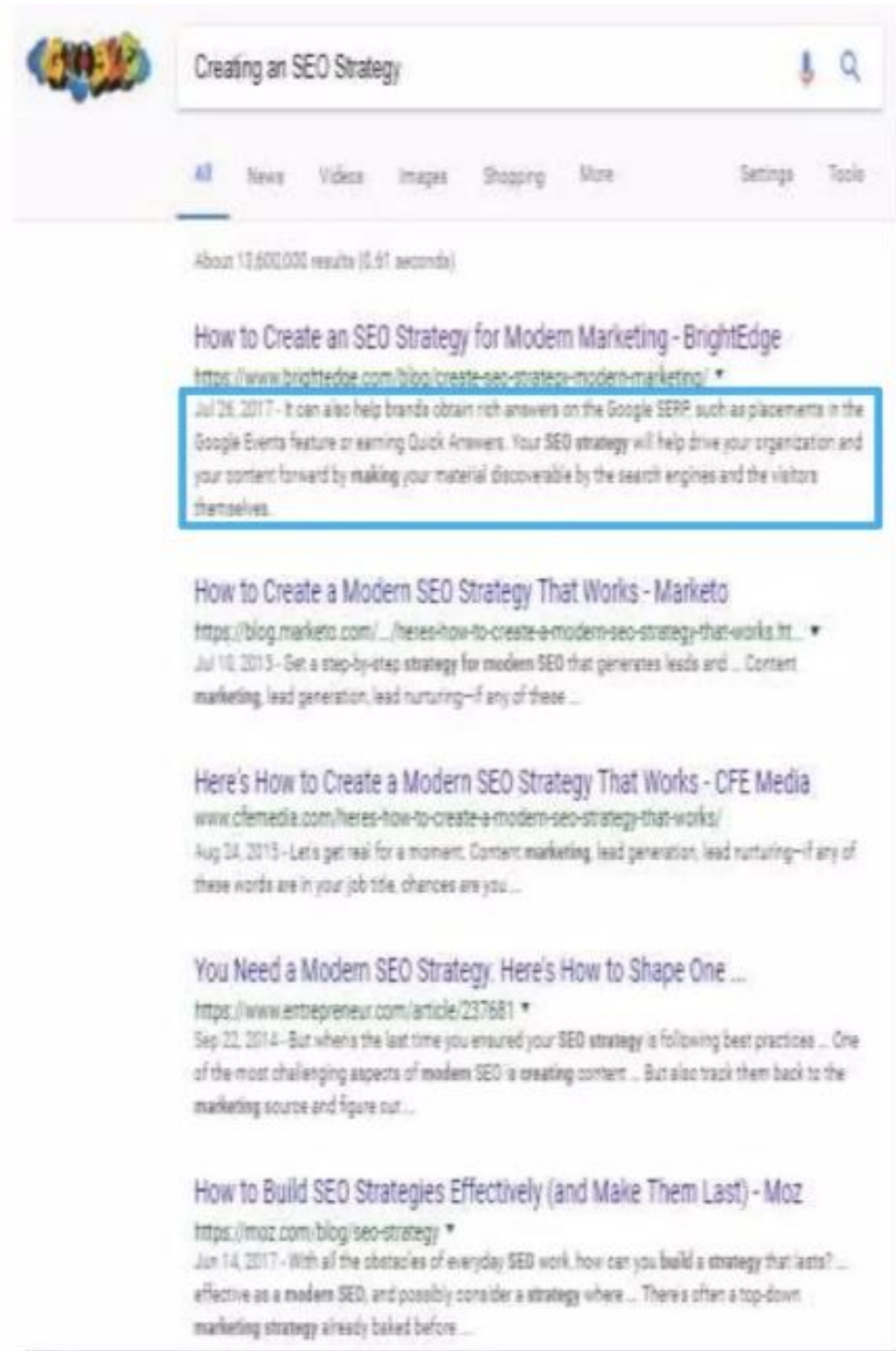
## What it looks like in the source code:

### Recommendation

- Use H1 only once per page
- Make sure the H1 is keyword rich and unique
- You can use H2 and H3 tags multiple times, but keep them unique from page to page
- Keep header tags in order



# Meta Description



## What is it?

A description of what your web page is about. It will also show up as the page summary on the SERP.

## Why is it important?

An engaging and descriptive meta description will attract more clicks when your pages shows up in search results. Think of it as a mini ad.

## Recommendation

- Include strong call-to-actions
- Make sure keyword is included early in the first line
- Make them unique for each page
- Try to keep them around 120-150 characters long



# Creating Engaging Content

1. Prioritize profitable topics – Identify the 1-3 keywords or keyword phrases that relate to your topic
2. Tune content to your audience – Balance informative content for the human reader with keyword placement
3. Keep readers clicking – Ensure you have interlinking from your content to other related topics within your site
4. Keep published content optimized – Track content performance and optimize accordingly





# Content - Keyword Research Factors



## RELEVANCE

- Is your content and website addressing a need for this keyword?
- Would a customer expect to land on your site after searching for this keyword?



## SEARCH VOLUME

- High search volume indicates higher potential visits, but may also indicate higher ambiguity (for example “holidays” vs “luxury holidays in Maldives”)



## USER INTENT

- Is the customer looking to purchase, learn, or be entertained?



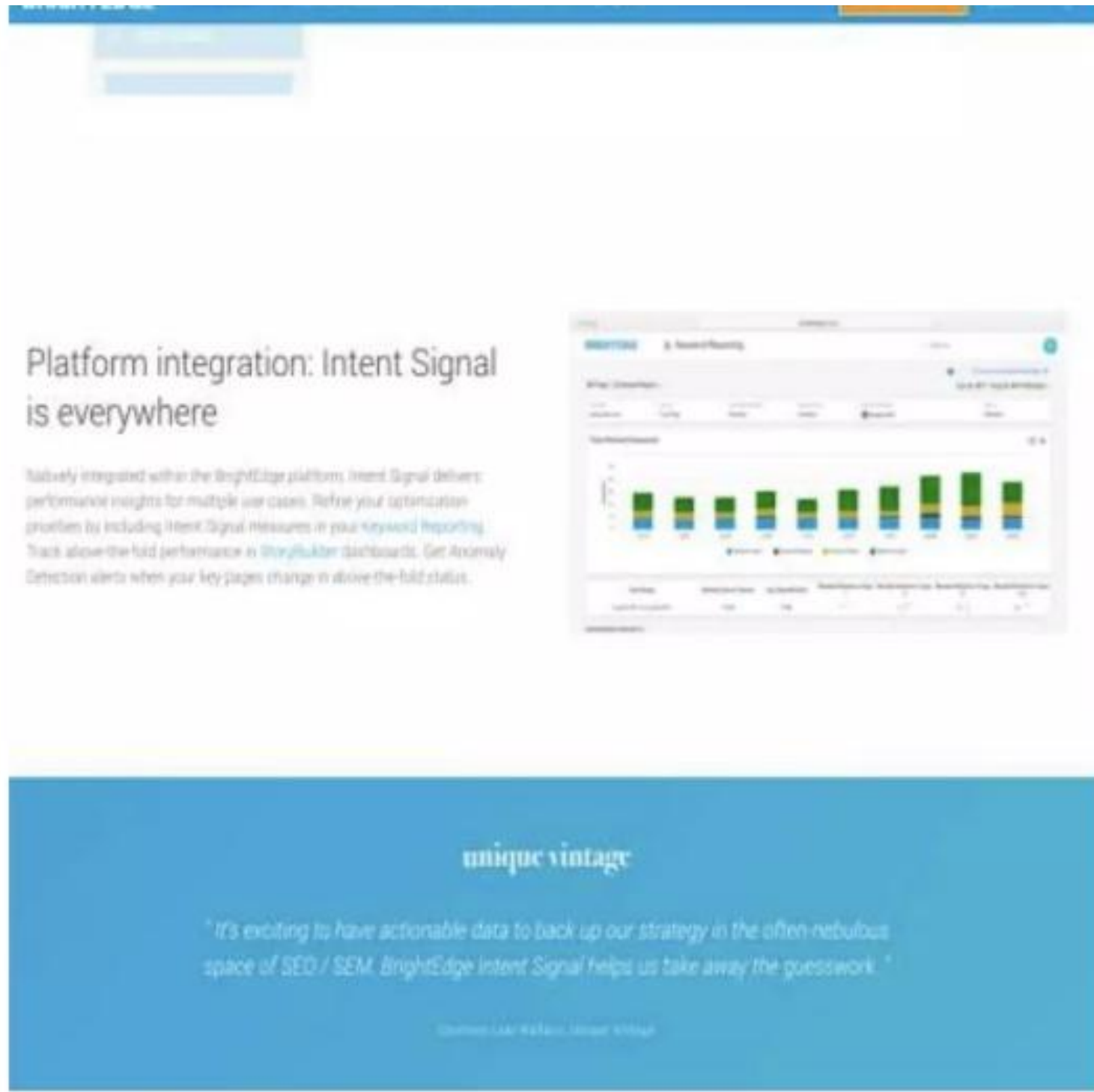
## Competition (Difficulty to rank higher)

- Long tail terms offer lower search volume, but higher relevance; head terms offer higher potential visits, but lower relevance
- Head terms: High competition
- Long tail: Low competition





# Content - Internal Links



## What is it?

**Internal links** are links that go from one page on a domain to a different page on the same domain. They are commonly used in main navigation within a site.

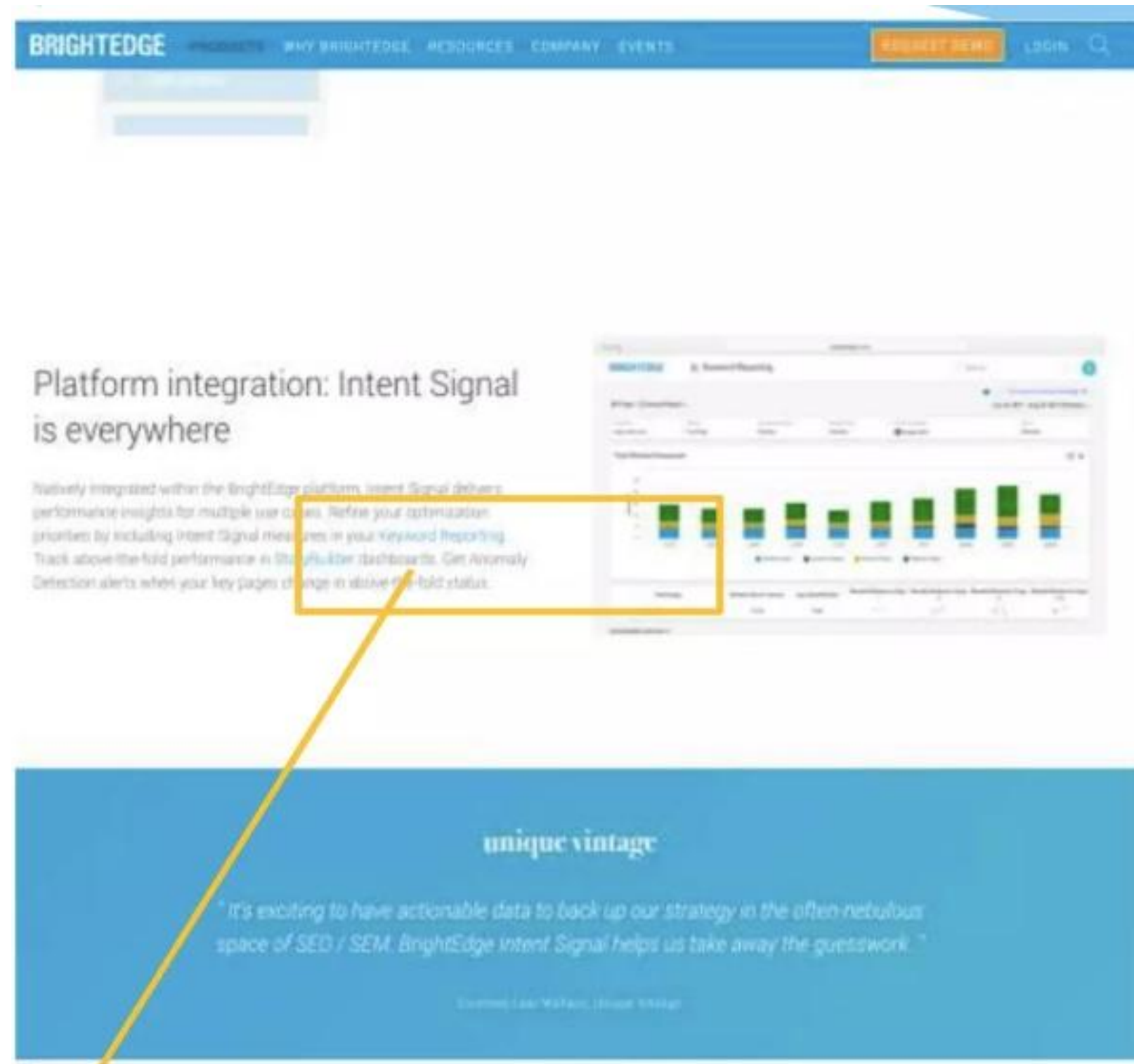
## Internal links are often useful for several reasons:

- To allow users navigate a website
- To help establish information hierarchy for the given website
- To help spread link equity across a website
- To use as a "soft conversion" CTA for top-of-the-funnel content

[Vijay kant Keyword Reporting](https://www.vijaykant.com/products/s3/keyword-reporting)



# Content - Anchor Text



## What is it?

**Anchor text** is the visible text on a page that can be clicked on and links to another page. In the example to the left, the login page has an internal link to another section on the BrightEdge site. The anchor text that can be seen, “Content Performance”.

## What it looks like:

The anchor text comes after the link in the source code.

```
<a href="https://www.vijaykant.com/products/s3/keyword-reporting">vijay kant Keyword Reporting</a>
```

```
<a href="https://www.vijaykant.com/products/s3/keyword-reporting">vijay kant Keyword Reporting</a>
```



# Promote Your Good Content

Work doesn't stop when you hit "Publish."  
Make sure to include promotional and cross-promotional efforts in your Content Strategy

Use following channels to amplify your content:

- Link Building
- Social Media
- Paid Advertising etc,



End of Lecture